A month of onchain payments shows a competitor a company's payroll, suppliers and treasury moves

Fictional company, for illustration

Payment	*What the public ledger shows*	*What a competitor learns*	*What the public sees with controlled disclosure*
Salaries	Three transfers totalling $29,450 on the 25th of each month	Headcount and individual pay	Three payments of [redacted] to [redacted] ✓ *Verified by the network*
Supplier invoice	$184,000 to an address that analytics tools label Kestrel Components	The main supplier, its price and terms	One payment of [redacted] to [redacted] ✓ *Verified by the network*
Customer receipt	$420,000 in from an address labelled Orion Retail	A key customer and the contract size	One receipt of [redacted] from [redacted] ✓ *Verified by the network*
Treasury transfer	$2.4M to an exchange deposit address	A likely sale, before it settles	One transfer of [redacted] to [redacted] ✓ *Verified by the network*

What controlled disclosure means

The network still verifies every payment, but amounts and counterparties are readable only by the company, its auditor and regulators.

What it means

Businesses do not need secrecy, they need to choose who can read their records. Without that, putting payroll and treasury onchain publishes them.

Note: Fictional company, names and amounts. *Sources:* a16z, Investing in Seismic; Dfns and Zama, confidential institutional infrastructure.